

METEORITES

Yes, meteorites. Having already noted that we were witnessing one mania with various outlets, the June 29, 1990 issue of *The Elliott Wave Theorist* asked, "If speculation in art, collector coins, old cars and baseball cards doesn't convince you, read this article from *Insight* magazine."

"The prices people are willing to pay for meteorites have gone to ridiculous extremes."

The interior glories of these space rocks are revealed when they are cut with diamond-tipped mineral saws. Prices range from a dollar or two per gram, up to \$500 per gram. Some think the Connecticut-based ■■■ is after a new, lucrative market: well-heeled professionals in the Northeast who will buy two or three pricey meteorites for home display in the same way that they would buy a few good prints and who will pay much more than scientific collectors who shop around for a good price.

"They always appreciate. I don't know of any meteorite I have bought that I could not sell in three months for more money." A dealer in Colo., who says he grossed about \$70,000 last year, says his business has been "growing in leaps" and quadrupled from 1988 to 1989, mostly due to

the publicity.

The real action is among a few dozen collectors in the United States and Europe. Some say the yen-heavy Japanese have recently entered meteorite collecting, investing huge sums.

■■■■■ senses that a crash is near, due to illiquidity and talk of investment in meteorites. "We are in the last phase. We had a surge and are soon due for a top."

"People can collect whatever they want. But there is the issue of selling finds only to those with large amounts of money," says the curator of one museum meteorite collection. "This prices specimens out of museum range. The prices people are willing to pay for meteorites have gone to ridiculous extremes."

Meteorite prices will have crashed to Earth by the bottom of the depression. Can you imagine being a Japanese man explaining to his grown son ten years from now why he spent half a million dollars on a rock that now sits in the display case and has no liquidity and little value? Such an outcome is inevitable. If you don't believe it, I have some tulip bulbs to sell you at a bargain: half their peak prices of 359 years ago.

BASEBALL CARDS

Perspective

One of *The Elliott Wave Theorist's* more esoteric forecasts was the January 1993 statement, made at the height of baseball's popularity, that "Baseball faces its largest drop in attendance since it became the national sport." The analysis that led to that conclusion will be detailed in our upcoming book. However, this book's focus is